

Daily Current Affairs Digest

Comprehensive Notes from Morning Current Affairs Session • 10 September 2026

1. TRISHNA Mission (India-France Joint Satellite Mission)

- India and France are jointly launching a new Earth-observation mission named **TRISHNA** (Thermal infraRed Imaging Satellite for High-resolution Natural resource Assessment).
- Planned launch year: **2027** (exact date not yet announced).
- Mission will be jointly led by **ISRO** (India) and **CNES** (Centre National d'Études Spatiales, France).
- Purpose: high-resolution thermal infrared imaging of Earth for monitoring drought, weather, climate patterns and cyclones.
- Satellite altitude: approximately **761 km**; payload capacity around **1000 kg**.
- Launch vehicle: **PSLV** (Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle) — India's own rocket, first used in **1993-94** (mission PSLV-D1). The 2027 TRISHNA launch will use a **4-stage** PSLV with **solid and liquid propulsion**.
- Context: this follows the earlier **PSLV-C61** mission, which was a failure — making global trust in India's launch capability significant.
- Related: India's own **AOS-05** Earth Observatory Satellite was launched on **4 September**.
- Also noted: India's **Gaganyaan** mission (India's first human spaceflight, ISRO) is scheduled for 2027; and India-Japan's **LUPEX** mission (Lunar Polar Exploration Mission) to the Moon's surface is expected around 2027-2028.

2. Triple Cyclones Near Hawaii & El Niño

- The **USA** has declared an emergency as **three hurricanes** have formed simultaneously near **Hawaii** (Pacific Ocean, North America continent).
- Cause: warming of Pacific Ocean waters has intensified the **El Niño** phenomenon (also called the 'Naughty Boy' or 'Christ Child').
- Mechanism: the cold **Peru Current** (also called the **Humboldt Current**) off South America warms up, triggering El Niño, which causes either severe drought or excess rainfall/cyclones.
- Names of the three storms: **Lowell** (most significant), **Kiko/Karina**, and **Mario**.
- Regional names of tropical cyclones: **Hurricane** (North America), **Cyclone** (Indian Ocean), **Willy-Willy** (Australia), **Typhoon** (China/Japan/Philippines/South China Sea), **Tornado** (USA - localized).

3. Polity, Sports & General Awareness (from recent Stenographer/SSC paper)

- Parliament of India** holds **3 sessions** annually — Budget Session, Monsoon Session, Winter Session (memory aid: 'BMW').
- Article 352** of the Constitution deals with National Emergency; it is imposed by the **President** on the advice of the **Cabinet**.
- Chandrayaan missions**: Chandrayaan-1 (2008), Chandrayaan-2 (2019), Chandrayaan-3 (2023).
- 1991 Economic Reforms**: LPG (Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation) reforms introduced under then Finance Minister **Dr. Manmohan Singh**.
- World Press Freedom Index**: India ranks **157th**; released by **Reporters Without Borders (RSF)**.
- K2 peak**: located in the **Karakoram Range**; height **8,611 metres** — world's second-highest peak.
- Norway Chess Championship 2026**: winner — **R. Praggnanandhaa** (India).
- SAARC** (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation): 8 member countries; headquarters in **Kathmandu**, Nepal; India is regarded as the largest/leading member.
- Commonwealth Games**: India finished **4th** in the medal tally with a total of **39 medals**.
- Dance forms: **Bharatanatyam** — classical dance form of **Tamil Nadu**; **Garba** — folk dance of **Gujarat**, performed during Navratri; **Sarhul festival** — celebrated in **Jharkhand**.

4. 'Spectrum' Rocket – Germany's Private Launch

- Spectrum** is a newly launched **private rocket**, developed by **Germany** through the company **Isar Aerospace**.
- Launched from **Andøya, Norway** (Norway's capital: **Oslo**) on **5 September 2026**.
- It is described as **Europe's first private company rocket**.
- It covered a distance of **100 km** in about **4 minutes** — a notable achievement.
- Target orbit: **Low Earth Orbit (LEO)**; the rocket has **2 stages** and carries a payload of about **1,000 kg**, including **5 small satellites**.
- Fuel used: **liquid oxygen and propane**.
- Comparable Indian private rocket: **Vikram-1**, powered by India's private rocket engine named **Agnibaan/Everest** engine (developed by Indian private space companies).

5. Russia–North Korea 'Friendship Bridge'

- Russia has built a new **1 km, 2-lane road bridge** connecting Russia and **North Korea**, opened on **7 September 2026**.
- Background: on the Korean Peninsula, **South Korea** (supported by the USA) lies south of the **38th Parallel / Demilitarised Zone (DMZ)**, while **North Korea** (supported by Russia and China) lies north.
- The bridge is named the '**Friendship Bridge**', dedicated to a Russian soldier, **Yakov Novichenko**, who once saved the life of North Korea's first ruler, **Kim Il-sung**.
- It connects **Moscow** (Russia's capital) with **Pyongyang** (North Korea's capital), built over the **Tumen River**.
- Russia and North Korea share a border of about **17 km**; North Korea's remaining border is with China.
- Comparable India example: the **Kartarpur Corridor** (India-Pakistan 'friendship route'), which was closed after India's **Operation Sindoor**.

6. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh's Sri Lanka Visit

- India's Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** visited **Sri Lanka** — the first visit by an Indian Defence Minister in **38 years** (the last was by **K.C. Pant**).
- He met Sri Lanka's President, **Anura Kumara Dissanayake** (referred to as 'Aruna ji' in the session).
- India signed an **MoU with Sri Lanka** to upgrade **L-70 anti-aircraft guns**.
- Indian Navy ship **INS Udaygiri** (a Nilgiri-class stealth frigate, **Project 17A**) also visited **Colombo Port**.
- Both nations agreed to strengthen **trade and defence cooperation**.
- Joint military exercises between India and Sri Lanka include: **Mitra Shakti**, **SLINEX**, **Dosti**, and **DAVIKS** exercises.

- Sri Lanka facts: known as the '**Teardrop of India**'; old name **Ceylon**; capital **Colombo** (Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte is the official/administrative capital); major community — the **Sinhalese**; city of **Jaffna**; separated from India by the **Palk Strait**.
- Additional defence note: **AK-203 rifles** (replacement for AK-47) are being manufactured in **Amethi** with Russian collaboration; the **Adani Group** has now joined this production.

7. Global Fintech Fest 2026

- Inaugurated by **PM Narendra Modi**; hosted in **Mumbai**, starting **8 September 2026**.
- This is the **6th edition** of the fest (first held in 2020).
- Key points highlighted: focus on **next-generation technology** in defence and finance; India's GDP growth for **April-June 2026** was **7.8%**, expected to touch **8%** by December; inflation stated to be under control; **UPI** completed **10 years** and is now adopted by **11 countries**.

8. Awards & Honours

- **Kalinga Ratna Award**: given by the **Sarala Sahitya** organisation in **Odisha**; this year conferred on **Justice Dipak Misra**, former **45th Chief Justice of India** (Supreme Court).
- **APJ Abdul Kalam Jan Seva Puraskar 2026** (16th edition): awarded to **Kishor Makwana**, Chairperson of the **National Commission for Scheduled Castes** (est. 1992; became independent from the Scheduled Tribes Commission from 2004; Article 338 covers SC Commission, Article 338-A covers ST Commission), under the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**.
- Notes on APJ Abdul Kalam: called '**People's President**'; authored '**Wings of Fire**' and '**Ignited Minds**'; Wheeler Island in Odisha renamed **APJ Abdul Kalam Island**.

9. Sports News

- **Pickleball World Cup 2026**: hosted in **Da Nang, Vietnam** — the first time this event was hosted in **Asia**. Total **82 countries** participated. India finished **4th** (improved from 7th in 2025) with a total of **41 medals** (7 gold, 17 silver, 17 bronze). India Pickleball Association, headquartered in **Mumbai**, was formed in **2008**.
- **World Sub-Junior Weightlifting Championship** (ongoing in **South Africa**): Indian weightlifter **Kiya Banerjee** (age 21, 47 kg category, body weight ~45 kg) lifted **140 kg** and won a **silver medal**; another Indian, **Madhura Kar**, won **gold** in the 52 kg category.

10. Books, Bhupen Hazarika & Himalaya Diwas

- Vice President **C.P. Radhakrishnan** launched a book titled '**Bhupen Hazarika**' in **Assam**, edited/written by **Ankuran Dutta** and **Nani Gopal**.
- Bhupen Hazarika (from Assam, noted musician) honours: **Bharat Ratna (2019)**, **Padma Vibhushan (2012)**, **Dadasaheb Phalke Award (1992)**. The **Bhupen Hazarika Setu** (also called **Dhola-Sadiya Bridge**) connects Assam and Arunachal Pradesh over the **Lohit River** (~9.15 km long).
- **Himalaya Diwas (Himalayan Day)** observed on **9 September** every year, first proposed by **Uttarakhand** in **2015**, to promote conservation of the Himalayas — about **12% of glaciers** have already melted. 2025 theme: '**Global Warming and the Himalaya**.' (Note: World Great Himalayan Day / Mount Everest Day is observed on 29 May.) Himalayan ranges (north to south): Great Himalaya, Lesser Himalaya, and the Shivalik range.

11. Quick Revision – Additional Current Affairs

- **Tripura** recorded a **zero drop-out rate** in Classes 1-5 (primary schools) from **2013-14 to 2025-26**, aided by the Mid-Day Meal Scheme (focus: preventing drop-outs and ensuring child nutrition).
- **27th World Knowledge Forum** held in **Seoul, South Korea**.
- **PACT** (mentioned in defence/heavy-vehicle context) relates to achieving **zero-carbon emission** in heavy vehicles.
- India-China **Corps Commander-level meeting** held for the first time in **Arunachal Pradesh**.
- **WHO: Bhutan** became a country with **zero rabies cases**.
- India co-sponsored a UN resolution on ending **child marriage** (marked around **27 November**).
- '**Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar**' campaign relates to marine/coastal cleanliness (note: Lucknow ranked poorly on clean-air metrics).
- **International Literacy Day**: observed on **8 September**.
- **75 years of Dinamalar** (a Tamil-language newspaper) celebrated; a related new map was launched and approved by the **UNGA (UN General Assembly)**.
- **72nd National Film Awards** to be distributed in **Gujarat** this year (usually held in Delhi).

Practice MCQs – Based on Today's Current Affairs

Attempt the following multiple-choice questions covering all the current affairs discussed above.

Q1. What is the name of the upcoming joint Earth-observation satellite mission between India and France?

- (a) Aditya Mission (b) TRISHNA Mission (c) Chandrayaan Mission (d) Aryabhata Mission

Answer: (b) TRISHNA Mission

Q2. Which French space agency will jointly launch the TRISHNA mission with ISRO?

- (a) ESA (b) DLR (c) CNES (d) Roscosmos

Answer: (c) CNES

Q3. In which year was India's PSLV rocket first used?

- (a) 1988 (b) 1993-94 (c) 2001 (d) 2008

Answer: (b) 1993-94

Q4. The three hurricanes near Hawaii are linked to the intensification of which climatic phenomenon?

- (a) La Niña (b) El Niño (c) Indian Ocean Dipole (d) Jet Stream Shift

Answer: (b) El Niño

Q5. What is the local name for tropical cyclones that occur in the North Atlantic/Eastern Pacific (e.g., near Hawaii/USA)?

- (a) Typhoon (b) Willy-Willy (c) Hurricane (d) Cyclone

Answer: (c) Hurricane

Q6. How many sessions does the Indian Parliament hold in a year?

- (a) 2 (b) 3 (c) 4 (d) 5

Answer: (b) 3 (Budget, Monsoon, Winter)

Q7. Article 352 of the Indian Constitution deals with which type of emergency?

- (a) State Emergency (b) Financial Emergency (c) National Emergency (d) Constitutional Emergency

Answer: (c) National Emergency

Q8. India's rank in the World Press Freedom Index, released by Reporters Without Borders, is:

- (a) 127 (b) 142 (c) 157 (d) 161

Answer: (c) 157

Q9. Mount K2 is located in which mountain range?

- (a) Himalayas (b) Karakoram Range (c) Hindu Kush (d) Aravalli Range

Answer: (b) Karakoram Range

Q10. Who won the Norway Chess Championship 2026?

- (a) Magnus Carlsen (b) Viswanathan Anand (c) R. Praggnanandhaa (d) Gukesh D.

Answer: (c) R. Praggnanandhaa

Q11. 'Spectrum', Europe's first private company rocket, was developed by which country?

- (a) France (b) Germany (c) Norway (d) UK

Answer: (b) Germany (by Isar Aerospace)

Q12. The Spectrum rocket was launched from which location?

- (a) Kourou, French Guiana (b) Baikonur, Kazakhstan (c) Andøya, Norway (d) Cape Canaveral, USA

Answer: (c) Andøya, Norway

Q13. India's comparable private rocket to Germany's Spectrum is:

- (a) GSLV Mk III (b) Vikram-1 (c) Agni-V (d) SSLV

Answer: (b) Vikram-1

Q14. Russia's new 'Friendship Bridge' (opened 7 September 2026) connects Russia with which country?

- (a) China (b) North Korea (c) South Korea (d) Mongolia

Answer: (b) North Korea

Q15. Russia and North Korea's Friendship Bridge is built over which river?

- (a) Amur River (b) Yalu River (c) Tumen River (d) Han River

Answer: (c) Tumen River

Q16. Which Indian city/route is described as India's own 'friendship route' with Pakistan, closed after Operation Sindoor?

- (a) Wagah Border (b) Kartarpur Corridor (c) Attari Road (d) Line of Control Route

Answer: (b) Kartarpur Corridor

Q17. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh's recent visit to Sri Lanka was the first by an Indian Defence Minister in how many years?

- (a) 25 years (b) 30 years (c) 38 years (d) 45 years

Answer: (c) 38 years

Q18. India and Sri Lanka signed an MoU to upgrade which defence equipment?

- (a) BrahMos missiles (b) L-70 anti-aircraft guns (c) T-90 tanks (d) Su-30 jets

Answer: (b) L-70 anti-aircraft guns

Q19. INS Udaygiri, which visited Colombo Port, belongs to which class of frigates?

- (a) Shivalik-class (b) Nilgiri-class (c) Kamorta-class (d) Talwar-class

Answer: (b) Nilgiri-class (Project 17A)

Q20. AK-203 rifles, being manufactured in Amethi with Russian collaboration, are a replacement for which rifle?

- (a) INSAS (b) AK-47 (c) SLR (d) M4 Carbine

Answer: (b) AK-47

Q21. Who inaugurated the Global Fintech Fest 2026 held in Mumbai?

- (a) President Droupadi Murmu (b) PM Narendra Modi (c) Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman (d) RBI Governor

Answer: (b) PM Narendra Modi

Q22. India's GDP growth rate for April-June 2026, as mentioned at the Global Fintech Fest, was:

- (a) 6.5% (b) 7.2% (c) 7.8% (d) 8.5%

Answer: (c) 7.8%

Q23. The Kalinga Ratna Award 2026 (given by Sarala Sahitya, Odisha) was conferred on:

- (a) Justice D.Y. Chandrachud (b) Justice Dipak Misra (c) Justice N.V. Ramana (d) Justice U.U. Lalit

Answer: (b) Justice Dipak Misra (45th CJI)

Q24. The APJ Abdul Kalam Jan Seva Puraskar 2026 (16th edition) was given to whom?

- (a) Kishor Makwana (b) Arif Mohammed Khan (c) Buta Singh (d) Ram Nath Kovind

Answer: (a) Kishor Makwana, Chairperson, National Commission for Scheduled Castes

Q25. The National Commission for Scheduled Castes operates under which Article of the Constitution?

- (a) Article 330 (b) Article 338 (c) Article 338-A (d) Article 340

Answer: (b) Article 338 (338-A is for Scheduled Tribes Commission)

Q26. The Pickleball World Cup 2026 was hosted in which country, marking its first hosting in Asia?

- (a) Thailand (b) Vietnam (c) Indonesia (d) Malaysia

Answer: (b) Vietnam (Da Nang)

Q27. India's rank and total medal count at the Pickleball World Cup 2026 were:

- (a) 2nd, 55 medals (b) 4th, 41 medals (c) 7th, 30 medals (d) 1st, 60 medals

Answer: (b) 4th, 41 medals

Q28. Indian weightlifter Kiya Banerjee, who lifted 140 kg at the World Sub-Junior Weightlifting Championship in South Africa, competes in which weight category?

- (a) 43 kg (b) 47 kg (c) 52 kg (d) 59 kg

Answer: (b) 47 kg

Q29. Vice President C.P. Radhakrishnan recently launched a book on which noted musician from Assam?

- (a) Zubeen Garg (b) Bhupen Hazarika (c) Hemanta Mukherjee (d) S.D. Burman

Answer: (b) Bhupen Hazarika

Q30. Bhupen Hazarika was awarded the Bharat Ratna in which year?

- (a) 2015 (b) 2019 (c) 2012 (d) 1992

Answer: (b) 2019

Q31. The Bhupen Hazarika Setu (Dhola-Sadiya Bridge) is built over which river and connects which two states?

- (a) Brahmaputra River; Assam-Nagaland (b) Lohit River; Assam-Arunachal Pradesh (c) Barak River; Assam-Manipur (d) Teesta River; Assam-Sikkim

Answer: (b) Lohit River; Assam-Arunachal Pradesh

Q32. Himalaya Diwas (Himalayan Day) is observed every year on:

- (a) 5 June (b) 9 September (c) 29 May (d) 22 April

Answer: (b) 9 September

Q33. Which state first proposed observing Himalaya Diwas, starting in 2015?

- (a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Uttarakhand (c) Sikkim (d) Jammu & Kashmir

Answer: (b) Uttarakhand

Q34. Which Indian state recorded a zero drop-out rate in primary schools (Classes 1-5) from 2013-14 to 2025-26?

- (a) Kerala (b) Tripura (c) Odisha (d) Sikkim

Answer: (b) Tripura

Q35. The 27th World Knowledge Forum was recently held in:

- (a) Tokyo, Japan (b) Seoul, South Korea (c) Singapore (d) Beijing, China

Answer: (b) Seoul, South Korea

Q36. According to the WHO, which country recently achieved zero rabies cases?

- (a) Nepal (b) Bangladesh (c) Bhutan (d) Sri Lanka

Answer: (c) Bhutan

Q37. SAARC's headquarters is located in:

- (a) New Delhi (b) Dhaka (c) Kathmandu (d) Colombo

Answer: (c) Kathmandu

Q38. In the recently held Commonwealth Games, India's overall rank and total medals were:

- (a) 2nd, 61 medals (b) 4th, 39 medals (c) 6th, 45 medals (d) 3rd, 50 medals

Answer: (b) 4th, 39 medals

Q39. Bharatanatyam is the classical dance form of which Indian state?

- (a) Kerala (b) Odisha (c) Tamil Nadu (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (c) Tamil Nadu

Q40. The Sarhul festival is celebrated mainly in which Indian state?

- (a) Jharkhand (b) Chhattisgarh (c) Bihar (d) West Bengal

Answer: (a) Jharkhand